



Whispers of Wonders

May, 2026

Hello, Readers	3
The World Around Us	4
 Into the Wild	5
 Beyond Our World	6
 New Discoveries	7
 In Conversation with a Quantum Physicist	8
Our Creative Voices	10
 A story to tell	11
 From the Easel	12
 A moment Captured	13
 From Our Bookshelf	14
The Playful Mind	15
 Puzzles & Riddles	16
 Look closely	17
 Find the words	18
 Word Scrambles	19

Hello, Readers

Welcome to the very first issue of our little magazine: Whispers of Wonders. Inside you will find stories of animals from faraway lands, mysteries from the outer space, review of children's books, latest news in the domain of science and technology. We will also publish creative stories, photographs and paintings. There are fun puzzles and riddles included for you at the end.

We plan to publish this magazine monthly. Feel free to send us your own creativities to publish in the next issue.

We had plenty of fun making this magazine. Enjoy reading it, share with your friends and family, and let us know your valuable opinion.

Thank you 💕.

Aadrita Chattopadhyay
Editor-in-chief

A full-page background image of an orca leaping from the water. The orca is captured mid-jump, with its body arched and its tail fluke visible. Water is splashing around its tail. The background shows a calm sea and a distant, hazy horizon. The entire image has a light blue color overlay.

The World Around Us

Into the Wild

Pandas - the Gentle Bears of *China*

Deep in the mountain forests of China dwells one of the gentlest animals on earth - the Panda. Although they belong to the bear family, Pandas behave quite differently than



their wild cousins - the Grizzly bear and the Polar bear. They are calm and peaceful animals, who spend most of the day eating bamboos. Pandas love eating bamboos and can munch up to 40 pounds of bamboo in one day. Even though bamboos are their favorite food, they also can snack on grass, little animals, eggs etc. You can easily identify a Panda bear from its Black-and-White appearance with fluffy, furry coat. These cute animals are also good at swimming and climbing. Baby

pandas are usually very tiny when they are born and stay close to their mommies.

The Majestic Orcas

Have you ever seen an orca? Orcas are some of the strongest and fastest swimmers in the ocean. They are found in oceans all around the world and live in close family groups called pods. Each pod has its own special “language” of clicks and whistles to communicate with one another.

Orcas are highly intelligent animals and are well known for their striking black-and-white appearance. They eat fish, squid, seals, sea lions, penguins, and even sharks. When hunting, the members of a pod work together like a team. Some create waves to wash seals off floating ice, while others surround schools of fish to trap them more easily.



Interestingly, even though they are called

killer whales, orcas actually belong to the dolphin family. These beautiful ocean travelers remind us how intelligent, powerful, and fascinating life beneath the waves can be.



Beyond Our World

Pluto is a distant world with strange mountains and icy grounds. It was once considered the ninth planet of our solar system. But, in 2006, a scientific definition of planet was put forward. To be a planet, an object must satisfy these three factors:

1. it must have a specific orbit
2. it must be spherical in shape
3. it must clear its orbit of debris

Pluto travels through a region called the Kuiper belt that is filled with asteroids, icy rocks and dusts. Poor Pluto could not clear up its orbit and was no longer considered a planet. It is now considered a dwarf planet. Do you know that there are other dwarf



planets in our solar system? We have Eris, Ceres, Haumea, Makemake.

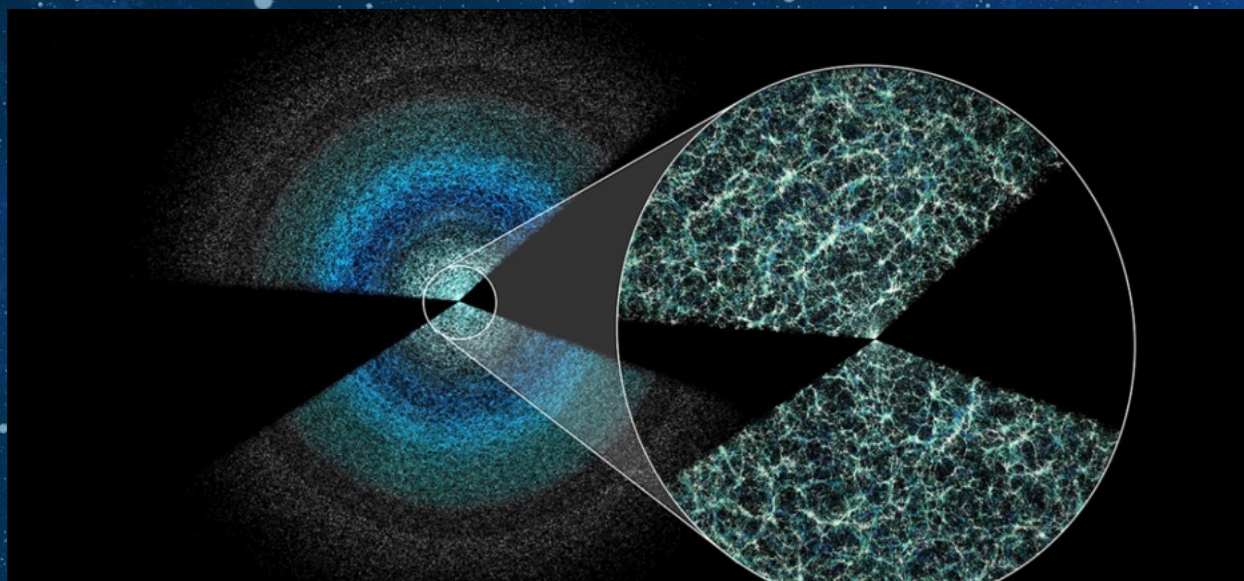
Pluto has five moons: Charon, Hydra, Nix, Kerberos and Styx. Among them, Charon is the biggest one. Together, they move around the solar system as best friends. Scientists say that Charon is so large compared to Pluto's own size that they have strong influence on each other.

People still argue over Pluto's status. Some say, it should be re-classified as a planet while others believe Pluto should remain a dwarf planet. Interestingly, Pluto doesn't mind how people see it. Long before people discovered it, Pluto and Charon were already quietly traveling through the darkness of space together — and they will continue their journey for many years to come.



New Discoveries

There are many many galaxies in the universe, filled with billions of stars, gas, dust and many planets. Human beings have always tried to know about these distant worlds. So, they decided to observe the night skies to create a map of our universe. Scientists installed DESI (Dark Energy Spectroscopic Instrument) which is a powerful instrument attached to a telescope in the desert of Arizona. They used a technique called the spectroscopic analysis to study the light coming from the stars. The light carries hidden information about the galaxies they come from and the path they traveled. Together they disclose the positions of the galaxies scattered throughout the universe. This project started 5 years ago. So far, DESI has already mapped 47 million galaxies. It looks like a giant cosmic web with clusters of galaxies and the void in between them. This map will help scientists understand the universe better. It will give clues about the possible fate of the universe - whether our universe will continue expanding forever or someday collapse together. I feel very happy to learn about the mysteries of the universe. It is really fun to learn more about them.



Fun fact: Some stars in the night sky are so far away that their light takes many years to reach Earth. This means that when we look at them, we are actually seeing light that started its journey long ago. Some of those stars may not even exist anymore!



In Conversation with a Quantum Physicist

An interview by:
Aadrita Chattopadhyay

For this month's interview, I spoke with my daddy, Dr Siddhartha Chattopadhyay, who is a theoretical quantum physicist at National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST). I asked him curious questions about science, and I learned many interesting things from our conversation. I hope you enjoy it and learn something new too!



Q: What is quantum physics?

A: Quantum physics is the study of subatomic particles.

Q: So, what are subatomic particles?

A: Good question. Our physical universe is made up of some fundamental particles. All the things that you see in nature are made up of particles like electron, proton, and neutron. But proton and neutron are not fundamental particles. If you probe them, then you will find that they are made up of Quarks.

Think of baking a cake. You will need ingredients such as flour, sugar, milk. So, they are kind of an analogy that all the things that you see in nature are made up of all these raw ingredients, which are the fundamental particles.

And the scientists who study those particles need to know Quantum physics because the motion of those particles are governed by the laws of Quantum physics. This spoon here is a macroscopic object. In 3 dimensional space this spoon has a specific well-defined position. In the quantum world, a quantum particle like electron, can be in two positions at the same time. So, you see, this may appear weird. It does not follow the rules that we “see” in the world around us. So, you have to device lot of instruments to study those particles and infer from them how the fundamental particles behave in the quantum world.

Q: Really interesting! Never knew that. Why did you choose to be a physicist?

A: When I was in high school, I learnt about all the inventions of modern physics like the development of quantum physics, development of semiconductors and superconductors, and how it transformed our lifestyles. Okay? Then I also read the theory of relativity that was proposed by Albert Einstein in 1905, almost 120 years back. And all these things stimulated me to study more about physics.

Q: Which scientist inspired you the most?

A: Stephen Hawkins motivated me a lot. You can read about him too, may be, when you are in high school.

Q: Have you ever discovered anything interesting?

A: Yes, a few, I suppose. I have found something interesting on quantum interference. When you throw two rocks on a lake, the ripples created by the first rock changes by the incoming ripples created by the second rock. But unlike the rocks which follow the laws of classical mechanics, when two waves interfere in the quantum world, they exhibit a very fundamental property of quantum particles. And I observed that quantum interference through my own calculations.

Q: Do you have a lab? Do you use any fancy tools for your research?

A: I have an office space. I am doing simulation, so I don't need a lab in the conventional sense. But to do those simulations, you need big, high power computers. There are some computers that we call work stations and they are somewhat like our desktop computers, but has more memory and more power. Okay? Then there are also High Performance Computing Clusters which have lot of computers connected together. Each of the computer does a specific task and can share the results among themselves.

Q: How do you study atoms if you cannot see them?

A: Atoms are extremely tiny, so scientists study them indirectly. One important method is called a scattering experiment. Scientists send particles toward atoms and observe how they scatter after collisions. Most particles pass through empty space inside the atom, but some are deflected by the heavy nucleus at the center. By studying this scattering carefully, scientists learn about atomic and molecular structure. My own work studies how electrons scatter from molecules, which are much more complicated than single atoms.

Q: Do scientists like to work as a team or on their own?

A: It depends. If it is an experiment, then you need many people to work together because experimental labs contain different instruments, different knobs that you have to control at different time, so you need a lot of people who work together. For the simulation also people need to work together, but you can do it on your own if you have access to the computers. In my case, I mostly work by myself, but I also discuss regularly with my colleagues.

Q: When you get stuck, do you ever feel like giving up?

A: Not really. You see, scientific discoveries take long time, sometimes it takes years and years of efforts to finally come to a conclusion. So, sometimes you can feel like giving up, but you just have to wake up the next day and do your work.

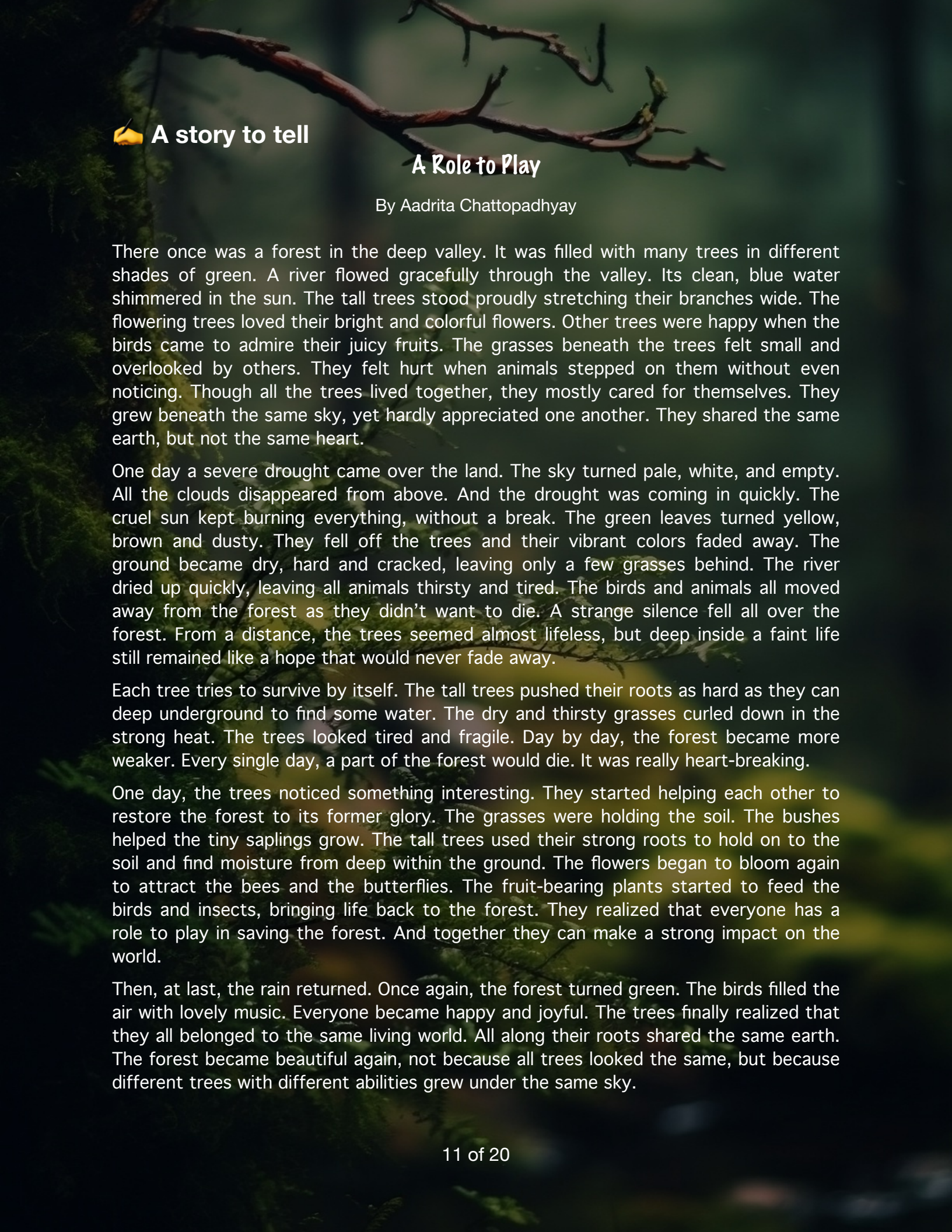
Q: What would you say to children who are interested in science?

A: Stay close to nature and observe how the world works. If you do not understand something, keep thinking about it and asking questions.

Long ago, people did not understand eclipses and created stories to explain them. Over time, science helped people discover what was truly happening. Many scientific discoveries begin when people carefully observe nature and become curious about it.



Our Creative Voices



👉 A story to tell

A Role to Play

By Aadrita Chattopadhyay

There once was a forest in the deep valley. It was filled with many trees in different shades of green. A river flowed gracefully through the valley. Its clean, blue water shimmered in the sun. The tall trees stood proudly stretching their branches wide. The flowering trees loved their bright and colorful flowers. Other trees were happy when the birds came to admire their juicy fruits. The grasses beneath the trees felt small and overlooked by others. They felt hurt when animals stepped on them without even noticing. Though all the trees lived together, they mostly cared for themselves. They grew beneath the same sky, yet hardly appreciated one another. They shared the same earth, but not the same heart.

One day a severe drought came over the land. The sky turned pale, white, and empty. All the clouds disappeared from above. And the drought was coming in quickly. The cruel sun kept burning everything, without a break. The green leaves turned yellow, brown and dusty. They fell off the trees and their vibrant colors faded away. The ground became dry, hard and cracked, leaving only a few grasses behind. The river dried up quickly, leaving all animals thirsty and tired. The birds and animals all moved away from the forest as they didn't want to die. A strange silence fell all over the forest. From a distance, the trees seemed almost lifeless, but deep inside a faint life still remained like a hope that would never fade away.

Each tree tries to survive by itself. The tall trees pushed their roots as hard as they can deep underground to find some water. The dry and thirsty grasses curled down in the strong heat. The trees looked tired and fragile. Day by day, the forest became more weaker. Every single day, a part of the forest would die. It was really heart-breaking.

One day, the trees noticed something interesting. They started helping each other to restore the forest to its former glory. The grasses were holding the soil. The bushes helped the tiny saplings grow. The tall trees used their strong roots to hold on to the soil and find moisture from deep within the ground. The flowers began to bloom again to attract the bees and the butterflies. The fruit-bearing plants started to feed the birds and insects, bringing life back to the forest. They realized that everyone has a role to play in saving the forest. And together they can make a strong impact on the world.

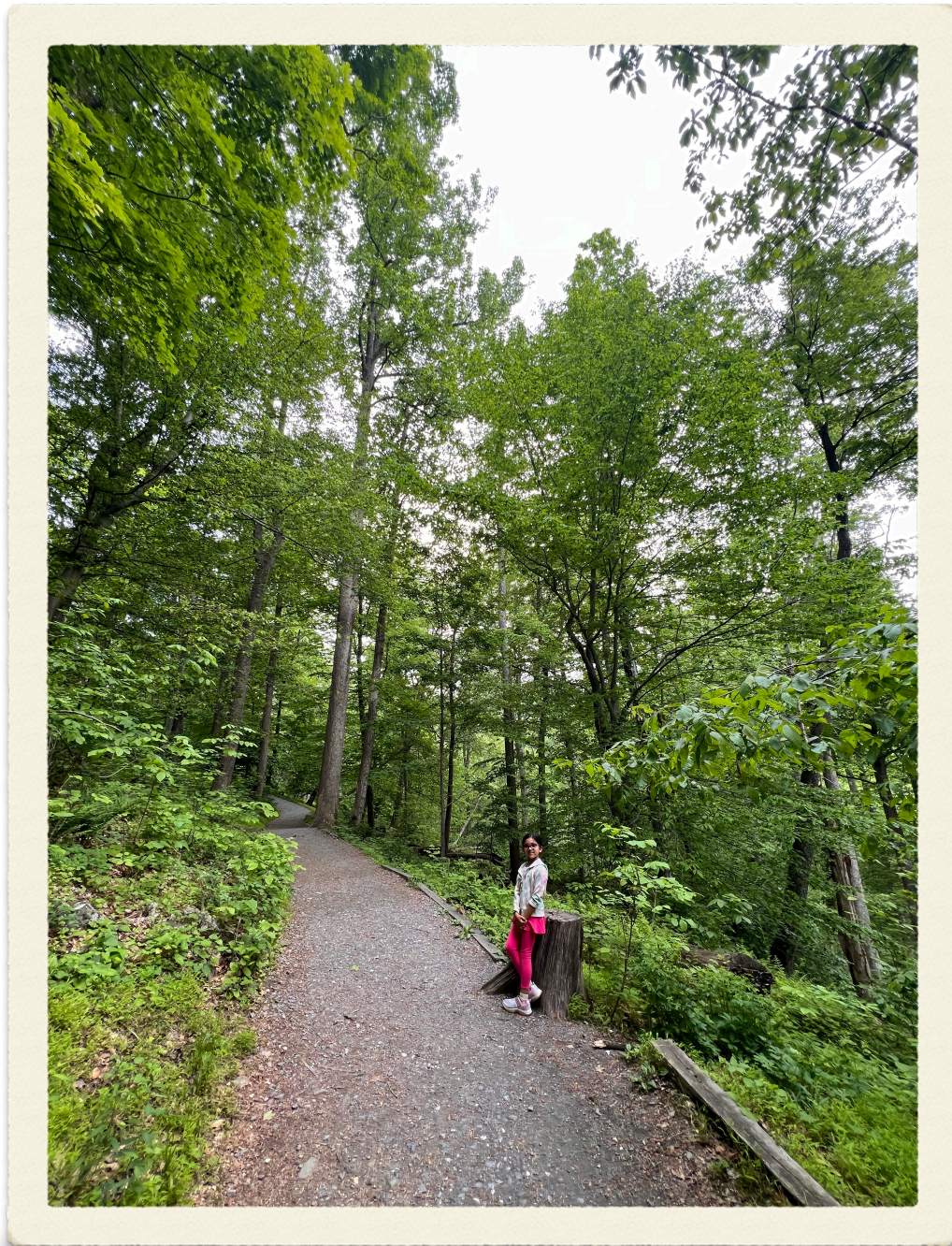
Then, at last, the rain returned. Once again, the forest turned green. The birds filled the air with lovely music. Everyone became happy and joyful. The trees finally realized that they all belonged to the same living world. All along their roots shared the same earth. The forest became beautiful again, not because all trees looked the same, but because different trees with different abilities grew under the same sky.

 From the Easel



A painting by: Aadrita Chattopadhyay

 A moment Captured



Among the forest trails and endless green.
Photo Courtesy: Dr. Siddhartha Chattopadhyay

From Our Bookshelf

Here is the review of a sweet book we read this month. Hope this helps you in your next visit to the local library 

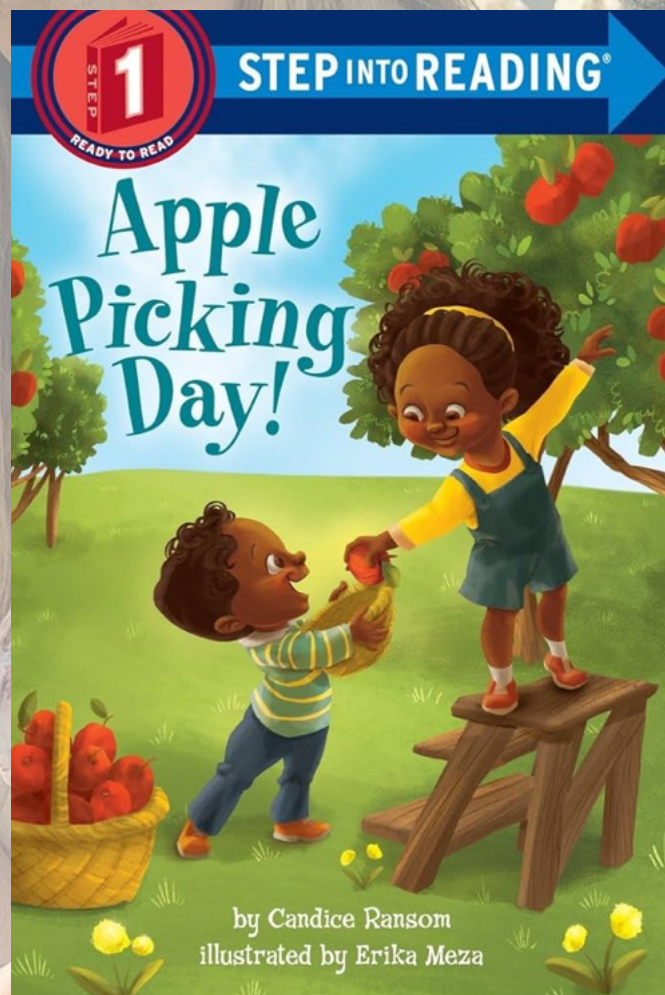
Apple Picking Day by Candice Ransom

Yesterday I read a book: Apple Picking Day! It was a very good book. It is about a boy and a girl who go on a tractor to pick up apples. Those apples are very juicy. They shared some. And in one of the pages, the boy found a wiggly worm inside an apple, Ew! He said “yuks”.

This book reminds me of the time I went to a pumpkin patch with my friend. It was a big orchard with lots of fresh fruits. The story in this book also takes place on a farm, so it felt similar to my experience.

I particularly liked the front cover where the boy is standing next to a basket and the girl is on a ladder and she picks up apples from a tree. It is a rhyming book, so it is fun to read. Each page has a picture in it.

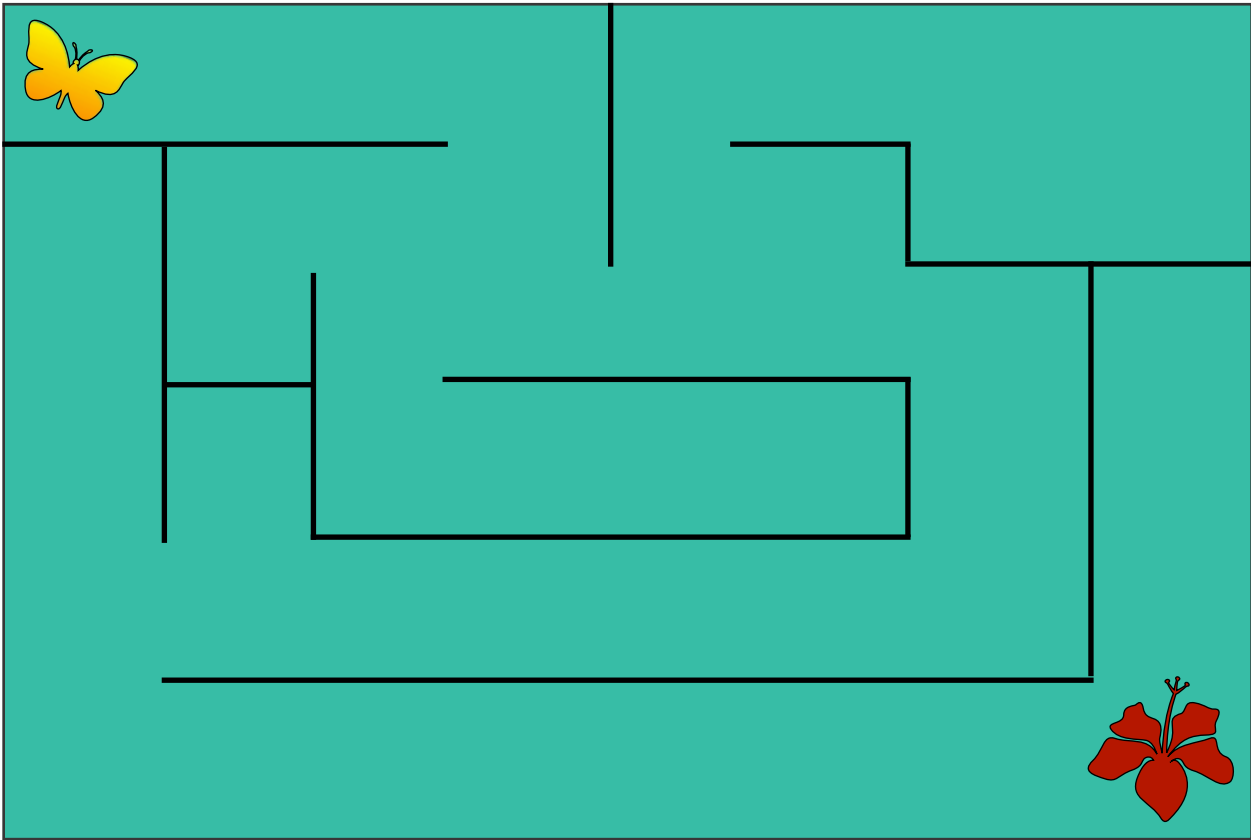
It is so fun to read books, like this one. If you get a chance, please read this book. I am sure, you will like it.





The Playful Mind

Puzzles & Riddles



- What can you catch but not throw?
- What kind of cup doesn't hold water?
- Which question can you never answer "yes" to?
- What word begins with E and ends with E, but only has one letter?
- I have no wings, but I can fly. I have no eyes, but I can cry. What am I?

1. Cold 2. Cupcake 3. "Are you asleep?" 4. Envelope 5. Cloud

 Look closely

Spot the Difference. There are 7 differences in the images below. Find them.





Find the words

V	D	A	D	D	Y	A	P	B	L	X	W	G	B	U
D	N	J	U	O	Y	C	I	H	V	I	O	L	I	N
E	D	D	G	L	F	V	L	F	B	G	G	K	Y	E
N	O	F	R	H	T	S	G	U	I	T	A	R	R	D
T	N	R	H	I	N	O	R	A	G	D	D	G	I	A
I	K	B	K	K	H	R	I	U	G	E	K	H	B	I
S	E	L	H	W	F	C	M	Y	E	A	E	J	Y	S
T	Y	V	C	H	G	A	S	O	R	X	Y	E	X	I
I	N	I	G	A	O	H	J	Y	W	S	B	D	Q	E
H	K	W	W	L	G	V	H	X	R	F	O	X	J	S
R	P	Q	Y	E	H	V	X	O	T	V	A	R	R	Z
G	L	A	S	S	E	S	T	Y	Y	G	R	R	H	D
E	F	R	E	H	H	I	P	L	U	J	D	S	Y	C
S	W	D	P	A	P	E	R	D	Q	G	A	G	O	H
A	W	J	Q	U	D	P	F	T	C	W	A	T	E	R

- DADDY
- PILGRIMS
- GLASSES
- DONKEY
- WHALE

- ORCA
- VIOLIN
- GUITAR
- DAISIES
- WATER

- BIGGER
- KEYBOARD
- DENTIST
- PAPER
- RHINO

Word Scrambles

We jumbled the letters in the words below.

Rearrange them to find the meaningful words.

Hint: In some cases, you may find a word that is in plural.

The answers will be available in the next issue. Enjoy playing 😎!

• O-P-M-E-R-U-C-T

• C-R-A-B-L-E-E-T

• N-A-T-H-L-E-E-P

• S-T-R-A-N-L-E-N

• T-A-N-N-A-D-U-B

• D-E-R-M-I-S-A-M

